For the people of Sind, their own is to be praised.

In a proclamation of the royal code of conduct issued by Akbar to all officials, there are thoughts which echoed the same sentiments of active tolerance and compassion:

> The best prayer is service to humanity. They should welcome all with generosity, whether friends, foes, relatives or strangers. In particular they should be kind to the recluse and seek the company and advice of the pious.
>
> They should be ever watchful of the conditions of people, the big and the small (for) chief-ship or ruler-ship means to guard and protect… And they should not interfere in any person's religion. For, wise people in this worldly matter, which is transient—do not prefer that which harms. How can they then choose the dis-advantageous way in matters of faith—which pertains to the world of eternity? If he (the subject) is right, they (state officials) would oppose the truth (if they interfere); and if they have the truth with them and he is unwittingly on the wrong side, he is a victim of ignorance and deserves compassion and help, not interference and resistance.

The guiding principles reflected in sulh kul were essential for a just ruler of a plural kingdom. As Iqtidar Alam Khan describes it 'within this framework there was no scope for the operation of those provisions of the Sharia which imposed certain disabilities on the zimmis'. 'As in the wide expanse of the Divine compassion there is room for all classes and followers of all creeds,' wrote Jahangir, 'so…in his (Akbar's) dominions…there was room for the professors of opposite religions, and for beliefs good and bad, and the road to altercation was closed. Sunnis and Shias met in one mosque and Franks and Jews in one church, and observed their own forms of worship.'

In practical terms, the spirit of 'universal civility' or 'absolute peace' was reflected in the very concrete reality that all the ruling clans in Akbar's empire were now almost evenly balanced. No single group was in a dominant position to impose its will on another and even the Turanis, the largest group, now comprised just 24 per cent of the nobility. Moreover, some of the Turani and Irani mansabdars commanded units composed mostly of Rajputs and 'by the end of Akbar's reign, Kachhwaha mansabdars alone commanded more than 26,000 ordinary cavalrymen in Mughal